



△ The Battle of Guadalete



751 CE

PEPIN III BECOMES KING OF THE FRANKS

The Merovingian dynasty in Francia had become weak, dominated by the mayors of the palace, its most senior officials, drawn from the Carolingian family. In 751, the Carolingian Pepin the Short deposed the last Merovingian ruler Childeric III and, with the blessing of the Pope, had himself crowned king and restored royal authority.

< Pepin III “the Short”, Carolingian king

751 CE An Arab army of the Abbasid Caliphate defeats the Tang Chinese at the Battle of the Talas River

752 CE The Lombards conquer Ravenna, the last major Byzantine holding in northern Italy

755 CE The An Lushan Rebellion weakens the Tang Chinese empire

759 CE



750 CE

ABBASIDS OVERTHROW THE UMAYYADS

Growing discontent with the Syrian-based Umayyad caliphs led to a revolt by Abu al-Abbas al-Saffah, a descendent of Mohammad’s uncle. He defeated the Umayyad caliph and established his Abbasid caliphate in Iraq, where his successor al-Mansur founded Baghdad.

< Baghdad in the time of al-Mansur

756 CE Abd al-Rahman I declares the Umayyad caliphate of Cordoba

715–1450 MEDIEVAL ILLUMINATED BOOKS



Lavish hand-painted manuscripts, often of religious or historical works, were produced in the millennium after 500 CE, at first in monasteries but later, as literacy spread, for wealthy patrons.

c. 715 CE The Lindisfarne Gospels, named for the monastery where they were kept, have a jewel-encrusted outer binding.

781 CE The Godescalc Evangelistary is commissioned by the Carolingian ruler Charlemagne.

c. 1113 The Russian Primary Chronicle charts the history of Russia from early times to the accession of Vladimir III.

1405–08 The Book of Hours of Jean, Duke of Berry, and similar prayer collections become popular with rich patrons.